GitHub + VS Code | New Contributor Quick Guide

Windows & macOS • Repository: AkashM07/ComputerVisionTask

How collaboration works: Each contributor has their own **local copy** of the project. Editing and committing only change your computer; **pushing** publishes your commits to GitHub. Other teammates receive them by pulling after changes are merged.

1 Clone the repository (one time)

```
git clone https://github.com/AkashM07/ComputerVisionTask.git
cd ComputerVisionTask
code .
```

What these do: `clone` downloads the project; `cd` enters its folder; `code .` opens the current folder in VS Code. Alternatively use **File → Open Folder**. No `git init` needed after cloning.

2 Start a branch from the latest main

```
git switch main
git pull origin main
git switch -c feature/describe-task
```

Why: `main` is the shared baseline. `pull` gets its latest changes; `switch -c` creates and enters your own branch, so you can work without directly changing `main`.

3 Edit, review, and commit locally

```
git status
git add .
git commit -m "Describe the change"
```

What these do: `status` shows modified files; `add .` stages changes; `commit` saves a local snapshot. Check files before staging; avoid committing generated datasets, credentials, or temporary files. Follow the repo's `.gitignore`.

4 Push your branch and open a Pull Request

```
git push -u origin feature/describe-task
```

What happens: `push` uploads your branch commits to GitHub. On GitHub, open a **Pull Request** targeting `main` so teammates can review and merge the work. A push alone does **not** update `main`.

5 Sync after the Pull Request is merged

```
git switch main
git pull origin main
```

Your local `main` now includes the merged changes. Create a fresh feature branch for the next task.

If you see "Permission denied (publickey)"

```
git remote set-url origin https://github.com/AkashM07/ComputerVisionTask.git
git remote -v
```

This switches the remote from SSH to **HTTPS**. Sign in to GitHub if prompted, then retry the push.